



Installation

? What you'll learn

- How to install Cypress using npm, Yarn, or pnpm
- What you need before installing
- Advanced installation options

Install & Run

1. **Check Requirements:** make sure you meet the [system requirements](#) including operating system, installation of Node.js and a supported package manager.
2. **Run in your project root:** This will install Cypress locally as a dev dependency for your project.

npm yarn pnpm

```
npm install cypress --save-dev
```

3. **Open Cypress:** This launches the Cypress App so you can choose end-to-end (E2E) or component testing (CT) and start writing tests.

npm yarn pnpm

```
npx cypress open
```

4. **Write your first test:** Start with [E2E](#) or [Component Testing](#).



System requirements

Operating System

Cypress supports running under these operating systems:

- **macOS** ≥ 13.5 (*Intel or Apple Silicon 64-bit (x64 or arm64)*)
- **Linux** (*x64 or arm64*) see also [Linux Prerequisites](#) down below
 - Ubuntu ≥ 22.04
 - Debian ≥ 11
 - Fedora ≥ 43
- **Windows** 10 & 11 (*x64*)
- **Windows** 11 25H2 (*arm64, runs in [x64 emulation](#) mode, minimum Cypress [14.5.0](#) required*) - preview status
- **Windows Server** 2019, 2022 and 2025 (*x64*)

Node.js

- **Node.js** 20.x, 22.x, $\geq 24.x$

Follow the instructions on [Download Node.js](#) to download and install [Node.js](#).

Note that the [Node.js Snap for Linux](#) version manager is not recommended for use with Cypress. Attempting to use it as a non-root user may result in permissions errors.

If you're using a [Cypress Docker image](#), you'll find a fixed version of Node.js is pre-installed in the image. You select the Node.js version using the Docker image tag.

Package Manager

Cypress is installed using one of the following supported package managers:



Manager	Version	Docs
npm	<code>>=10.1.0</code>	Install npm
Yarn 1 (Classic)	<code>>=1.22.22</code>	Install Yarn Classic
Yarn (Modern aka berry)	<code>>=4.x</code>	Install Yarn Modern
pnpm	<code>>=8.x</code>	Install pnpm

Yarn users

[Yarn \(Modern\)](#) configuration using `nodeLinker: "node-modules"` is preferred. Cypress [Component Testing](#) is not currently compatible with the default setting `nodeLinker: "pnp"` which uses [Yarn Plug'n'Play](#).

pnpm configuration

The following configuration options enable Cypress to execute its `postinstall` script so it can install the Cypress binary into the [binary cache](#). If these configuration options are not set, then Cypress may skip the `postinstall` script execution and Cypress will not run.

The pnpm [side effects cache](#) uses and caches the results of (pre/post)install hooks and is not compatible with Cypress' own caching. Disable the pnpm [side effects cache](#), for example using the following command, executed in the root of your Cypress project:

```
pnpm config set side-effects-cache false --location project
```

[pnpm@10.0.0](#) and above require allowlisting `cypress`. Refer to the [pnpm settings](#) documentation for additional information. In [pnpm@10.4.0](#) and above, the CLI `add` option `--allow-build` can be used, for example:

```
pnpm --allow-build=cypress add --save-dev cypress
```

Browsers



Each Cypress release includes the Electron-bundled Chromium [browser](#).

The latest 3 major versions of the following browsers are also supported:

- [Google Chrome](#)
- [Microsoft Edge](#)
- [Mozilla Firefox](#) (*Firefox $\geq$ [141.0](#) requires Cypress $\geq$ [14.1.0](#)*)
- [WebKit](#) support is experimental

Hardware

- Local: Any modern dev machine works
- CI: At least 2 CPUs + 4 GB RAM (8 GB+ recommended for long runs or video recording)

Some issues you might run into in CI that could be a sign of insufficient resources are:

- Exiting early during `cypress run` or abruptly closing ("crashing")
- Frozen or missing frames in the video
- Increased runtime

Linux Prerequisites

Install required dependencies. See below under [Docker Prerequisites](#) for information on [Cypress Docker images](#). These already include the necessary dependencies.

Ubuntu/Debian

For Ubuntu 22.04 and Debian:

```
apt-get install libgtk-3-0 libgbm-dev libnotify-dev libnss3  
libxss1 libasound2 libxtst6 xauth xvfb
```

For Ubuntu $\geq$ 24.04 and optionally for Debian 13:

```
apt-get install libgtk-3-0t64 libgbm-dev libnotify-dev libnss3
```



```
libxss1 libasound2t64 libxtst6 xauth xvfb
```

Arch

```
pacman -S gtk3 alsa-lib xorg-server-xvfb libxss nss libnotify
```

Amazon Linux 2023

```
dnf install -y xorg-x11-server-Xvfb gtk3-devel nss alsa-lib
```

Docker Prerequisites

[Cypress Docker images](#) are available from [Docker Hub](#) and the [Amazon ECR \(Elastic Container Registry\) Public Gallery](#). These images, which are Linux (Debian) based, include all of the required dependencies pre-installed.

If you need Node.js, browser or Cypress version combinations which are not covered by the published Cypress Docker images, then the [cypress/factory](#) image allows you to generate your own customized Docker image easily.

If you are not using a Cypress Docker image, make sure that your base operating system is a Linux system listed in the supported [Operating Systems](#) above and that Node.js is installed in the image. It is recommended to have `unzip` installed. This avoids the Cypress binary installation falling back to a slower unzip method using Node.js.

Advanced Installation

If you have more complex requirements, want to level-up your Cypress workflow or just need help with troubleshooting, check out our [Advanced Installation](#) reference. You can also find instructions to [uninstall Cypress](#) in this reference documentation.

Continuous integration



Please read our [Continuous Integration](#) docs for help installing Cypress in CI. When running in Linux you may need to install some [system dependencies](#) or you can use our [Docker images](#) which have everything you need prebuilt.

Next Steps

[Open the app](#) and take it for a test drive!

Last updated on **May 18, 2026**

CONTENTS

